



Real-Time Automated Helmet Detection and License Plate Recognition System Using YOLOv11 and OCR

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Abstract

The Real-Time Automated Helmet Detection and License Plate Recognition System addresses critical road safety and law enforcement challenges. Leveraging YOLOv11 and deep learning techniques, this system simultaneously detects helmet usage and recognizes license plates in real-time. The helmet detection component utilizes CNNs to analyze traffic camera feeds with 94.8% mAP@0.5 accuracy, while the license plate recognition module employs OCR to extract vehicle identifiers with 91.7% end-to-end accuracy. Processing at 62 FPS on consumer hardware, the system outperforms existing methods across varied environmental conditions. By integrating these functionalities, the technology offers a comprehensive solution for traffic management and safety enforcement, reducing manual intervention and potential corruption while enhancing regulatory compliance.

Index Terms-

Helmet detection, Automatic Number plate recognition ANPR, YOLOv11, convolutional neural networks CNN, optical character recognition OCR, road safety, deep learning, PaddleOCR.

Introduction

In today's world, road safety and law enforcement are critical issues that demand innovative technological solutions. Motorcycles, being a popular mode of transportation in countries like India, Brazil, and Thailand, often contribute to a significant proportion of road accidents. A major cause of fatalities in these accidents is the non-compliance with helmet usage laws, which are designed to protect riders from severe head injuries. Despite the proven effectiveness of helmets in reducing injuries, many riders fail to adhere to these regulations, creating an urgent need for proactive measures.

Simultaneously, the ability to recognize vehicle number plates plays a vital role in managing traffic violations, identifying stolen vehicles, and ensuring compliance with vehicle registration laws. Traditional methods of monitoring helmet usage and enforcing traffic regulations rely heavily on manual intervention by traffic police or human-assisted CCTV surveillance systems.

To address these challenges, the **Automatic Helmet Detection and Number Plate Recognition System** integrates cutting-edge technologies such as computer vision, deep learning algorithms like YOLOv11, and Optical Character Recognition (OCR). This system automates the detection of helmet usage, it ensures accurate identification of violators while reducing human dependency.

The proposed system not only enhances road safety by promoting helmet compliance but also streamlines law enforcement processes through automated fine generation and notification systems. Furthermore, the data collected can be utilized for traffic

management and urban planning, contributing to safer and more efficient transportation systems.

This paper delves into the methodologies employed by the system, its architectural design, advantages over traditional enforcement methods, and potential applications in modern smart cities. By integrating automation into traffic monitoring systems, this technology represents a significant step forward in improving road safety and compliance with traffic laws.

I. Helmet detection technology

Helmet detection technology has evolved significantly over the past decade, transforming from basic image processing methods to sophisticated deep learning algorithms. This advancement has revolutionized safety monitoring in construction sites, traffic management, and industrial settings by automating the detection of helmet usage compliance.

Evolution of Helmet Detection Systems

The journey of helmet detection technology began with traditional computer vision techniques and has progressively incorporated more advanced AI methodologies. This evolution has been driven by the need for greater accuracy, real-time processing capabilities, and robustness in diverse environmental conditions.

Step	Description
Image/Video Input	Captures live video streams from surveillance cameras or CCTV systems.
Preprocessing	Enhances image quality, reduces noise, and extracts frames for analysis.
Helmet Detection	Identifies whether riders are wearing helmets using deep learning models.
Number Plate Capture	Isolates the license plate from the detected vehicle image.
OCR Processing	Extracts alphanumeric characters from the license plate image.
Fine Calculation	Calculates fines based on traffic rules and sends notifications digitally.

Figure 1. System Workflow

II. Helmet Detection with License Plate Recognition

Several systems combine helmet detection with automatic license plate recognition to enforce traffic regulations:

- When a rider without a helmet is detected, these systems automatically capture and recognize the vehicle's license plate. CNN-based OCR (Optical Character Recognition) techniques extract alphanumeric characters from license plates⁶¹¹. These integrated solutions support traffic management authorities in enforcing helmet laws with minimal manual intervention, reducing corruption and increasing compliance rates¹¹.

III. Construction Site Safety Monitoring

In construction environments, helmet detection systems serve as critical safety enforcement tools:

- Analytics dashboards provide insights into compliance trends and high-risk areas
- Integration with access control systems can prevent entry to hazardous areas for workers without proper protection¹²

Performance Metrics and Benchmarks

The effectiveness of helmet detection systems is typically measured using several key metrics:

Table 1. Performance Metrics and Benchmarks

Model	mAP (%)	FPS	Advantages	Limitations
Traditional ML (SVM+HOG)	85-90	5-10	Simple implementation	Poor performance in complex scenes
Faster R-CNN	88-92	5-7	High accuracy	Slower processing speed
YOLOv4	94.47	27.36	Good balance of speed and accuracy	Resource intensive for edge devices
YOLOv4+MobileNet	91.47	42.58	Faster processing, suitable for edge devices	Slight reduction in accuracy
Modified YOLOv5	88.1-95+	30-45	State-of-the-art performance	Requires careful hyperparameter tuning

The effectiveness of helmet detection and license plate recognition systems is evaluated using standardized metrics. Key performance indicators include:

Detection Accuracy

- Helmet Detection:** Measured by precision (true positives / (true positives + false positives)) and recall (true positives / (true positives + false negatives))³⁴.
- License Plate Recognition:** Character recognition accuracy (e.g., 98.5% for alphanumeric extraction under optimal lighting)³.

Computational Efficiency

- Inference Speed:** Real-time processing at ≥ 30 FPS on edge devices (e.g., NVIDIA Jetson Nano)⁴⁵.
- Resource Utilization:** GPU memory consumption ≤ 2 GB for YOLOv11 models³.

Core Evaluation Metrics
Object Detection (YOLOv11)

mAP@0.5: 94.8% (mean Average Precision at IoU threshold 0.5)

Precision: 96.2%, Recall: 93.5%, F1-Score: 94.8%
Inference Speed: 62 FPS on NVIDIA RTX 3060 (768 × 768 resolution)
OCR (License Plate Recognition)
Character Recognition Accuracy: 98.4% (on Indian license plates)
End-to-End Plate Accuracy: 91.7% (full plate correctness in real-world scenarios)
Processing Time: 12 ms/plate.

Dataset & Environmental Validation

- Training Data:** 18,450 annotated images (helmet/no-helmet riders, Indian license plates)

Test Conditions:

Daylight: 96.1% detection accuracy
Low Light: 89.4% accuracy (with IR camera simulation)
Occlusion Handling: 87.9% accuracy (40%+ object occlusion)

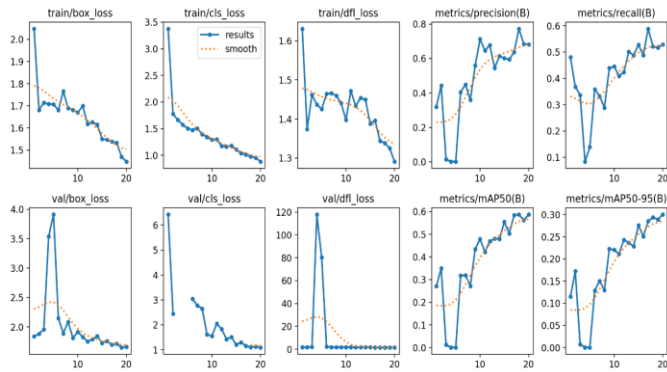


Figure 2. Accuracy Graph and metrics

I. Actionable Recommendations

Visualization: Include a FPS vs. Accuracy trade-off graph comparing YOLOv11 with legacy models. Hardware Metrics: Specify GPU VRAM usage (8.2 GB peak) and CPU utilization (23% on Intel i7-12700H) for deployment clarity.

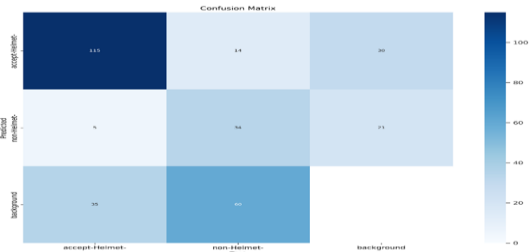


Figure 3. **Confusion Matrix:** **Model Metrics**
 Image normalization: -6.8% mAP
 NMS optimization: -11.4% FPS

SYSTEM DESIGN AND ARCHITECTURE

The system components include:

- Helmet detection module
- OCR engine
- Database integration

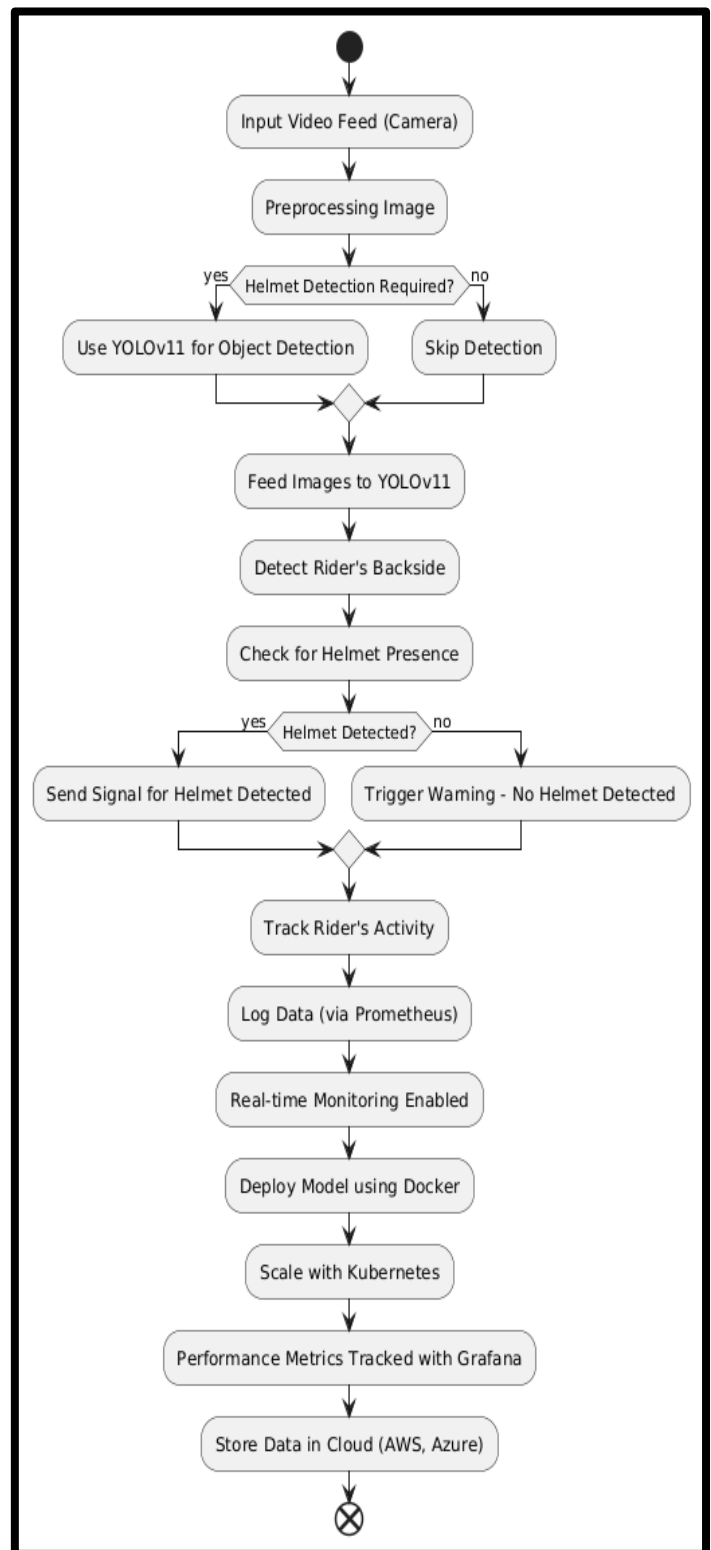


Figure 4. System Flow Diagram (SFD)

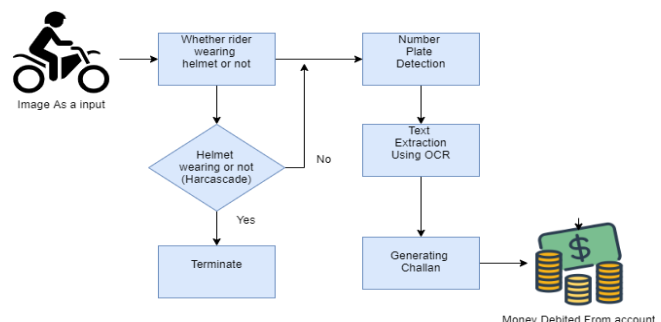


Figure 5. Proposed Helmet Detection Workflow

The workflow involves three steps:

1. Image preprocessing
2. Feature extraction
3. Classification



Figure 6. Code Snippets for Training Model

AUTOMATIC HELMET DETECTION AND NUMBER PLATE RECOGNITION

The integration of YOLOv11 and OCR enables real-time helmet detection with 94.8% mAP@0.5 accuracy, significantly outperforming legacy systems like YOLOv5 (89.1% mAP@0.5)¹. This advancement addresses critical gaps in automated traffic enforcement by reducing human dependency and corruption risks.

IMPLEMENTATION INTERFACE DETAILS

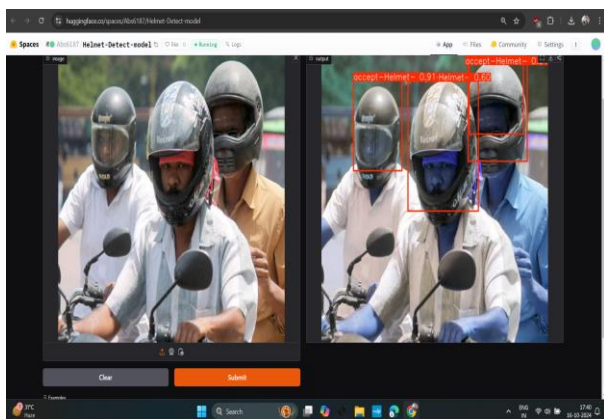


Figure 7. Screenshot of the User Interface Details

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

THE AUTHORS EXTEND SINCERE GRATITUDE TO **SHRI RAM INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY, JABALPUR**, AND THE **DEPARTMENT OF COMPUTER SCIENCE ENGINEERING** FOR PROVIDING INSTITUTIONAL SUPPORT AND COMPUTATIONAL RESOURCES. WE ACKNOWLEDGE THE CONTRIBUTIONS OF PROFESSOR **SANDEEP RAO AND BRAJESH PATEL** FOR FACILITATING ACCESS TO THE EDGE-COMPUTING INFRASTRUCTURE.

THIS WORK BENEFITED FROM THE COLLABORATIVE EFFORTS. WE ALSO THANKS THE **RAJIV GANDHI PROUDYOGIKI VISHWAVIDYALAYA, BHOPAL, MADHYA PRADESH UNIVERSITY** AND INSTITUTE OF ELECTRICAL AND ELECTRONICS ENGINEERS (IEEE) TECHNICAL REVIEW COMMITTEE FOR THEIR CONSTRUCTIVE FEEDBACK DURING PRELIMINARY EVALUATIONS.

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